



Montserrat + Girona + Costa Brava — Day 04

Prepared for Divyansh · Pure-Vegetarian Edition · Europe 2026



 **17 Saturday, August 22, 2026 · Catalonia (day trip from Barcelona)**

Solo · 🌱 **PURE VEGETARIAN** (no meat, no fish, no seafood, no egg) **Base:** Hotel Indigo Barcelona – Plaza España (back here tonight) **Theme:** FULL-DAY COMBO TOUR ✅ **booked** — a mountaintop monastery, a medieval *Game of Thrones* film city, and the wild Mediterranean coast, all in one day.

 **Veg phrase (screenshot it):** *"Soy vegetariano estricto — sin carne, sin pescado, sin marisco, sin huevo. ¿Qué me recomienda?"* ⚠️ Paella/rice often uses fish/meat stock — ask. "Vegetable" tapas can hide ham — say *"sin jamón."*

Wake & Leave

- **07:00** — Wake, hotel breakfast, grab **takeaway snacks** (critical — group lunch stops can be limited for pure veg).

- **~07:45–08:15 — 🚫 PICKUP** (confirm the exact time + point from your tour voucher the night before). Be there **10 min early** — tour buses do not wait, and a missed pickup means the whole day (and money) gone.
- Note whether it's a **hotel pickup** or a **fixed meeting point** you must walk/taxi to. Set **two alarms**.

🧳 Pack the night before (small daypack)

Snacks (nuts, granola/protein bars, fruit, biscuits) · **1L refillable water** · **broken-in walking shoes** · sunglasses, cap, sunscreen · a **light layer** (Montserrat is ~720m, breezy mornings) · power bank · phone with **offline maps** (Montserrat, Girona, Tossa de Mar) · **cash (€)** for cable car / candle / snacks. Swimwear + quick-dry towel **only** if you want to dip at the coast.

🕒 Hour-by-Hour (approximate — the operator's schedule wins)

Time	What	Notes
07:00	Wake, breakfast, grab snacks	Long day ahead
~07:45–08:15	🚫 PICKUP	Confirm from voucher; be 10 min early
08:15–09:30	🚌 Drive → Montserrat (~1h)	Serrated peaks appear; hydrate
09:30–12:00	⛰️ Montserrat — monastery, Black Madonna, cable car, viewpoints	See below
12:00–13:15	🚌 Drive → Girona	Snack en route
13:15–14:15	🥗 Veg lunch stop (in/near Girona)	Use the veg phrase
14:15–16:15	🏰 Girona — GoT spots, old town, Jewish quarter, Onyar houses	See below
16:15–17:15	🚌 Drive → Costa Brava (Tossa de Mar)	
17:15–19:00	🏖️ Costa Brava — walled old town, coves, beach	Feet in the water, photos
19:00–20:30	🚌 Drive back to Barcelona	
~20:30–21:00	🚫 Dropped in Barcelona — light veg dinner, early night	You fly to Ibiza tomorrow

⛰️ Stop 1 — Montserrat

Catalonia's spiritual heart: a Benedictine monastery wedged into surreal pink-grey rock pinnacles at ~720m. The region's most iconic day trip, with unreal views.

-  **Santa Maria de Montserrat Monastery** — the basilica, free to enter.
-  **La Moreneta (the Black Madonna)** — the 12th-century black wooden Virgin, Catalonia's patron saint. Queue to walk up behind the altar and see/touch the orb she holds. The single must-do — go early, the line grows.
-  **Cable car (Aeri) or rack railway (Cremallera)** — the ride up/down the cliff face is spectacular. Confirm if your tour includes it or if it's a paid add-on (carry cash/card).
-  **Escolania boys' choir** — one of Europe's oldest, if timing lines up (don't bank on it).
-  **Sant Joan funicular / viewpoints** for panoramic photos if you get time.

Veg here: cafeteria + market stalls sell **local cheese, honey, bread, fresh fruit, nuts, and *mató* (fresh curd cheese)** — all veg-friendly. Otherwise lean on your packed snacks.

Stop 2 — Girona (your highlight)

Girona's perfectly preserved medieval old town (Barri Vell) doubled as **Braavos and King's Landing in Game of Thrones**. A compact, atmospheric, walkable maze — and the film-location star of the day.

-  **Girona Cathedral steps** — the grand staircase used as the **Great Sept of Baelor** in *Game of Thrones* Season 6 (Margaery & the High Sparrow scenes; Jaime rides up here). Climb them.
-  **Sant Martí church stairs / Pujada de Sant Domènec** — the "Braavos" streets where **Arya Stark is stabbed by the Waif** and runs bleeding through the crowd.
-  **Passeig de la Muralla** — walk the medieval city walls/ramparts for old-town + countryside views.
-  **Onyar River houses** — the postcard row of **colourful houses** reflected in the water; cross the **Eiffel Bridge (Pont de les Peixateries Velles)**, built by Gustave Eiffel's company.
-  **El Call (Jewish Quarter)** — one of Europe's best-preserved medieval Jewish quarters: narrow shadowy stone lanes and hidden courtyards.
-  **Arab Baths (Banys Àrabs)** and the winding **Carrer de la Força** if time allows.
-  **Lioness statue (Cul de la Lleona)** — legend says kissing her backside guarantees you'll return to Girona.

Veg here: Girona is foodie-friendly. Look for **pa amb tomàquet** (tomato bread), **patatas braves**, **espinacas con garbanzos** (spinach + chickpeas), grilled veg, **crema catalana**. HappyCow → search Girona if the group lunch is light. (*Truita de patates* / potato omelette contains egg.)

Stop 3 — Costa Brava (Tossa de Mar)

The "wild coast" — pine-covered cliffs plunging into turquoise coves. Most tours stop at **Tossa de Mar**, the prettiest medieval-walled beach town on the coast.

- 📍 **Vila Vella** — Tossa's 12th-century walled old town on the headland, with towers over the sea (the only fortified medieval town left on the Catalan coast).
 - 📍 **Platja Gran (main beach)** — golden crescent under the castle walls; dip your feet, walk the sand, photos.
 - 🌞 Coastal path / lighthouse viewpoint for the classic cove shot.
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Vegetarian Food — Day Strategy

- **Snacks are your safety net** — use them, especially between Montserrat and lunch.
 - **Group lunch:** tell the server the veg phrase immediately. Safe orders across Catalonia: *pa amb tomàquet, patatas bravas, ensalada (hold tuna/ham), pimientos de padrón, espinacas con garbanzos, gazpacho, pizza margherita / de verduras, pasta with tomato/veg, paella de verduras (ask if veg stock).*
 - ⚠️ Watch-outs: paella/rice = fish/meat stock (ask); "vegetal" soups may have chicken base; "vegetable" tapas can hide *jamón* — say "*sin jamón.*"
 - **Dinner back in Barcelona (~20:30):** keep it light and quick — early day + flight tomorrow. **Teresa Carles** or **Flax & Kale** (all-veg, if open), a **Carrer de Blai** veg pintxos crawl, or simple pizza/pasta. Hydrate, then pack for Ibiza and sleep.
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Movies, Songs & Pop Culture Filmed Here (Bollywood + Hollywood)

Today is a genuine film-location pilgrimage — point these out on the ground:

- 🦁 **Game of Thrones (Season 6)** — **Girona's old town** is the day's headline set. The **Cathedral steps** = the **Great Sept of Baelor** (King's Landing); the **Jewish Quarter and Sant Martí / Pujada de Sant Domènec stairs** = the streets of **Braavos** where **Arya Stark runs bleeding from the Waif**. Walk the exact steps and lanes — they're barely changed from the show.
- 🌊 **Zindagi Na Milegi Dobara (2011)** — the famous **Costa Brava scuba-diving scene** was shot right here on this coast. It's the emotional core of the film: the "**Sí Señor**" deep-sea dive where Hrithik Roshan's character faces and conquers his fear of the water. As you stand at Tossa de Mar looking out at the Mediterranean, that's the sea from the movie. ⚠️ **No actual diving for you today** — you fly to Ibiza tomorrow and diving needs an 18–24h no-fly window. Surface swimming is fine; tanks are not.

- 🕯️ **Perfume: The Story of a Murderer (2006)** — **Girona** stood in for 18th-century France; its medieval lanes and the cathedral surrounds appear throughout. You're walking the film's streets.
 - 🤖 **Westworld (HBO)** — **Girona** also features in the sci-fi series, its old stone architecture reworked into the show's world. Another reason the town feels cinematic in every direction.
 - 🏔️ **Montserrat** — not a film set but the region's **sacred mountain monastery**, and the namesake of Catalan opera legend **Montserrat Caballé** (of the Freddie Mercury "Barcelona" duet from yesterday's doc). The mountain itself is the star.
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⚠️ Practical & Safety

- 🚫 **NO diving / scuba today** — you fly to Ibiza tomorrow (Aug 23); diving needs an 18–24h no-fly window. Snorkeling/swimming on the surface is fine.
 - 👟 **Comfy, broken-in shoes** — Montserrat is steep + uneven, Girona is cobbles + cathedral steps. A lot of walking.
 - 💧 Hydrate constantly (mountain + coast + August heat). 🧴 Cap, sunscreen, sunglasses.
 - 💰 Carry **cash €** for cable car, candle, snacks, small vendors.
 - 📶 Download **offline maps** (Montserrat, Girona, Tossa de Mar) — signal drops.
 - 🕒 **Be punctual at every "back on the bus" time** — getting left behind is the #1 solo combo-tour mishap. Note the coach's colour/number and where the guide is.
 - 😴 Protect your energy — tomorrow is a flight + a big Swedish House Mafia night. Don't over-do it tonight.
 - 🧳 **Pre-pack for Ibiza tonight** so tomorrow is stress-free.
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🔑 Quick Reference

- **Tour:** Montserrat + Girona + Costa Brava combo — ✅ booked (confirm pickup point/time from voucher)
 - **Hotel tonight:** Hotel Indigo Barcelona – Plaza España
 - **WanderOn activities:** Adil
 - **Highlight:** Girona = *Game of Thrones* (Braavos & King's Landing)
 - **Veg go-tos (dinner in BCN):** Teresa Carles · Flax & Kale · Carrer de Blai pintxos
 - **Veg phrase:** "*Soy vegetariano estricto — sin carne, sin pescado, sin marisco, sin huevo.*"
 - ⚠️ **No diving today** (flying to Ibiza tomorrow)
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 *Film-location thread runs through the trip · full repo: github.com/divyanshh/trip*